jurisdiction in India today is the opposite, with innumerable adjournments and consequent delays in the disposal of cases by sessions court judges. Kishan Singh had asked the lawyer, Asaf Ali, to represent his son, Bhagat Singh. At 9.50 a.m., F.B. Pool dawdled into the court-room. He saw Bhagat Singh's grandmother, Jai Kaur, and Ajit Singh's wife, Harnam Kaur, seated at a distance from him. The public prosecutor was Rai Bahadur Suryanarayan and the court-room was full of people attending in support of the accused. At the outset, Bhagat Singh made clear that he would answer none of his questions unless first recognized as a political prisoner. To prove that this was his proper designation, he wished to give a long speech setting out the manifesto of his party. What he said then provides us with the most penetrating insights into the thinking of this young revolutionary. It is hardly recalled these days by anyone anywhere. It is, however, a statement to which we will return later.